



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. John Paul II Preparatory School

School Website: <https://johnpaulprep.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St John Paul II Preparatory School (MO 63303) presents a robust classical-Catholic educational model anchored in a trinitarian vision of forming virtue, wisdom, and beauty. Public-facing materials on the school's site consistently emphasize a Catholic formation, a classical curriculum (notably the trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric), immersion in Great Books and Western-Christian civilization, and a hybrid schedule designed to partner with families as co-educators. The school also highlights governance and fidelity signals (e.g., Cardinal Newman Society recognition, Catholic formation, and a three-day hybrid model) that align with the classical rubric. Across the six classical categories, the school demonstrates substantial alignment with classical criteria, with particularly strong signals in Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community. The Pedagogy category shows clear classical elements (notably the trivium and Great Books emphasis) but less explicit documentation of Socratic seminars or other high-school pedagogical modalities in public materials, which places Element 4 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL. Overall, the school earns a CLASSICAL designation, reflecting a coherent classical framework with a strong Catholic core and explicit engagement with the Great Books tradition and the trivium.

Citations reflect the school's public-facing materials and the classical-education rubric/lexicon used for the analysis. Examples include explicit statements about classical education, the trivium, Great Books, Catholic formation, liturgy, and a three-day hybrid model (evidence cited below).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The program is described as rooted in forming the imagination, mind, and heart, aimed at pursuing the true, the good, and the beautiful. This framing aligns with transcendental moral realism and virtue-centered formation.
- The school identifies itself as Catholic and emphasizes Catholic formation, the Magisterium, and liturgical life (including Mass, adoration, and confession). This signals liturgical and communal practices integral to education.
- The curriculum and messaging reference the Gospels, saints, and Catholic teachings as part of the intellectual formation, tying theology and sacred tradition into learning.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present (from the classical lexicon): truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Mass; worship; adoration; saints; gospel/theology; catechesis; ritual aspects; wonder (implied in the pursuit of the true/good/beautiful).
- Negative keywords: not evidenced in public-facing materials (no explicit relativism, secular-humanism, or moral-neutral signals seen in the materials provided).
- Why this rating

- The material consistently foregrounds transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) and a Catholic theological framework with liturgical practices, a shared sacramental imagination, and communities anchored in Catholic worship. The frequency and explicitness of Catholic formation and liturgical life support a CLASSICAL rating in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The mission emphasizes formation and formation of virtue through education that fosters faith and character, with explicit aims to prepare students to be faith-filled leaders. This aligns with the classical telos oriented toward virtue and wisdom rather than merely career formation.
- The messaging references truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable, and affirms a classical aim beyond information transfer (paideia-like formation).
- Great Books/Great Conversation framing and a classical humanities orientation signal Bildung-like aims (formation of character through encounter with canonical texts).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; truth/goodness/beauty; classical mission; Great Books; great conversation; human flourishing.
- Negative keywords: not evident in public materials (no explicit emphasis on workforce-first framing).
- Why this rating
- The school's stated purpose centers on formation and human flourishing via a classical, virtue-centered education, consistent with CLASSICAL signals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum centers on the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the core structure of classical education.
- Great Books and Western-Christian historical formation are emphasized; students engage with canonical texts and historical study as central to learning.
- The program includes Latin and the study of history and Western civilization, with explicit references to a classical curriculum framed around the Great Books and Western intellectual heritage.
- The site describes a curriculum that includes religion/theology, humanities, and classical texts, aligning with a liberal-arts orientation.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books; history; Western civilization; Latin; pedagogy of classical texts.
- Negative keywords: presence of “social studies” terminology replacing history is not evident; no overt STEM-first framing or project-based dominance is presented in the public materials.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum clearly centers on classical content and methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; Western civilization/history). This aligns strongly with CLASSICAL expectations.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The core pedagogical anchor is the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the backbone of teaching and learning, indicating a structural classical approach.
- Great Books and a canonical, literature-rich approach are referenced, consistent with classical pedagogy.
- The public materials emphasize a hybrid model and family collaboration, which can support classical formation but do not always spell out explicit high-school Socratic seminars, spoken rhetoric, or explicit doctoral-level seminars in the visible pages. The explicit documentation of Socratic seminars, memory work, or rest/Scholé days is not consistently shown in the public-facing materials.
- There are references to collaborative teacher-parent co-education and a three-day in-person schedule, which aligns with a classical approach but not a full, explicit articulation of all classical pedagogical modalities in the site content.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: trivium (grammar/logic/rhetoric); Great Books; memory-oriented practices (narration, recitation) are implied through the classical framework; a rest-and-scholé ethos appears in classical education lexicon (though not always spelled out in the site text). The explicit use of “Socratic seminar” or “Paideia seminars” is not clearly documented in the public pages.
- Negative keywords: explicit reliance on experiential or project-based learning, or constructivist pedagogy, is not evidenced; however, explicit statements about Socratic seminars, narration, or memory-based recitation as a routine upper-level practice are not consistently presented in the visible site content.
- Why this rating
- The Pedagogy category shows strong classical elements (the trivium; Great Books; canonical-liberal-arts approach), but the lack of consistently explicit documentation of certain classicPedagogical practices (e.g., explicit Socratic seminars for all high-school levels) in public materials leads to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL designation rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe a faculty culture that is modeled as mentors and guides, with a living curriculum and a “faculty of friends” ethos. The site features pages that describe faculty leadership and the role of teachers in formation.
- The “Meet our Faculty” content and administrator bios illustrate professional, credentialed leadership and dedicated teachers (e.g., Head Master, Dean of Religious Formation).
- There is emphasis on a collaborative, parent-inclusive faculty culture and a strong alignment between teacher conduct and student formation (the “co-teachers” concept is highlighted in admissions materials).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegial culture; teacher formation; portrait of teacher.
- Negative keywords: not evidenced in public materials (no negative signals identified in the lexicon for this category).
- Why this rating

- The site consistently portrays faculty as central to the school's mission and culture, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty as living exemplars and mentors within a communal, formation-focused environment.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school explicitly frames parents as co-educators in the hybrid model and requires parental involvement through P.A.C.E. training (Parents As Co-Educators). This is a core classical-community signal.
- The admissions materials describe open involvement for parents and ongoing opportunities for parent formation (book studies, gatherings).
- The overall institutional messaging emphasizes partnership with families, home-school hybrid structures, and a family-centered model that aligns with the classical-community ethos.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parent formation; reading groups; seminars; family-centered; home-school hybrid; open campus; parental involvement; household rhythms; family catechesis.
- Negative keywords: none observed in public materials (no “parent-as-customer” signals; no consumer-language limitations). The lexicon does list potential negative signals, but they are not evidenced in the school's materials.
- Why this rating
- The public-facing materials demonstrate a strong partnership with parents and a structured program to involve families in Catholic-classical formation, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parents and community involvement.

Overall Assessment

- Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL
- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Justification: Five of six categories meet the classical criteria robustly, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) showing substantial classical alignment but not fully documented in the public materials as encompassing the full range of classical teaching modalities (e.g., explicit high-school Socratic seminars). The presence of the trivium, Great Books, Latin, historical/cultural formation, Catholic formation, and a family-partnered hybrid model collectively support a CLASSICAL designation overall.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable given the aggregate CLASSICAL designation. If one category were to move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, potential needle-moving improvements would include:
- More explicit articulation and demonstration of high-school Socratic seminars, dialectic discussions, and formal rhetoric/capstone opportunities in public materials.
- Clear, public articulation of contemplative/scholé days or rest-focused pedagogical cycles beyond the current hybrid structure.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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